

Runway Tools

Promotion Playbook for Fashion Brands

Organic + Paid + Community + Influencers — with a stage-based decision system.

Use this as a reference PDF for your Mentor AI and as a checklist for launches.

How to use this playbook

Promotion only works when the fundamentals are solid. If your product, pricing, and product page are weak, paid ads will only help you lose money faster.

- Pick one main platform and commit for 30 days. Consistency beats novelty.
- Choose tactics based on your stage (pre-launch, launch, post-launch, scale) — not what looks cool.
- Track a minimum KPI set: saves/share rate, link CTR, conversion rate, CPA, ROAS/MER, repeat rate.
- Use discounts like a scalpel, not a lifestyle. Protect contribution margin.

Decision shortcut

- Owned media: build the story and prove demand.
- Earned media: borrow trust (UGC, reviews, creator mentions).
- Paid media: buy attention for a proven offer (don't pay to test if people care).

1. Promotion map for fashion brands

Use three buckets to avoid confusion: **Owned** (you control it), **Earned** (others talk about you), and **Paid** (you pay to reach people). A healthy brand uses all three. Early-stage brands should go owned-first, then add paid to accelerate what already works.

Bucket	Examples	Best for	Main risk
Owned	Instagram/TikTok content, email list, WhatsApp community, website	Trust-building, demand proof, direct conversions	Inconsistent posting, weak narrative
Earned	UGC, reviews, influencer mentions, press, collabs	Credibility + social proof	You can't fully control it
Paid	Meta/TikTok ads, boosted posts, affiliate payouts, whitelisting	Scale a proven offer	Wasting money on bad creative/offer

Decision shortcut

- Owned: build the story and prove demand.
- Earned: borrow trust.
- Paid: buy attention to a proven offer (never to “test if people care”).

2. Choose promotion based on stage, not vibes

Most founders fail because they run random tactics. Pick tactics that match your current stage and bottleneck.

Stage	Your goal	What to post (organic)	What to run (paid)	What to measure
Pre-launch	Build a waitlist & clarity	Founder story, problem, moodboard, samples, BTS	Small spend: boost best Reel / IG engagement	Saves, DMs, waitlist signups
Launch / Drop	Convert attention into orders	Product story, try-ons, scarcity, proof, FAQs	Conversion ads, retargeting, creatives that already work	CVR, CPA, AOV, ROAS
Post-launch	Improve margin + repeat	Care tips, styling, UGC, reviews, restock updates	Retargeting + LTV campaigns	Repeat rate, MER, return rate
Scale	Systemize + diversify	Series content, collabs, community flywheel	Always-on + weekly creative testing	Creative hit rate, CAC by cohort

Bottleneck diagnosis

- Low views: your hooks/format are weak. Fix content, not ads.
- High views, low clicks: offer/positioning is unclear.
- Clicks, low sales: product page, pricing, trust, or sizing is broken.
- Sales, no repeat: quality, expectation, or customer experience is broken.

3. Storytelling that sells (without being cringe)

Fashion is emotional. You are not selling fabric — you are selling identity, status, belonging, and confidence. Use a repeatable story structure.

Story-to-sale structure (works on all platforms)

- Hook (0–2s): problem or curiosity.
- Proof: show fabric/fit/result (closeups, before/after, try-on).
- Context: why it matters (who it's for, when to wear it).
- Offer: price/value + drop details.
- CTA: DM keyword / link / comment.

What kills your storytelling

- Only posting product photos with no narrative or context.
- Being too polished on TikTok — no hook in the first second.
- Trying to be funny instead of clear (clarity beats creativity).

4. Content system that compounds

Random posting is not a strategy. Build a content system with 4 repeating content pillars.

Pillar	Purpose	Examples (fashion)	Best for
Product proof	Reduce doubt	Try-ons, fit checks, fabric closeups, reviews	Conversion
Lifestyle / identity	Create desire	Outfits in real life, “wear it to...”, mood edits	Top-of-funnel views
Education	Build authority	How to style, how to choose size, care tips	Trust + saves
Behind-the-scenes	Build connection	Design process, manufacturing, packing orders	Community + loyalty

Weekly cadence (simple)

- 3–5 Reels (mix proof + lifestyle + education).
- 2 carousels (education or drop story).
- Stories daily (BTS, polls, Q&A;).
- 1 community push (WhatsApp: value + soft CTA).

5. Free vs paid promotion: what to use when

Organic is slower but builds trust. Paid is faster but punishes weak fundamentals. Use paid only after you have: (1) clear offer, (2) strong creative, (3) a product page that converts.

Type	Cost	Speed	Trust	Best time to use
Organic content	Time	Slow–medium	High	Always (foundation)
Community (WhatsApp)	Time	Medium	High	Pre-launch + launches
Influencer seeding	Product cost	Medium	Medium–high	New products + social proof
Paid ads	Cash	Fast	Medium	When offer + creative already work
PR / press	Time or agency fee	Slow	High	Brand building, collabs, bigger drops

Budget ladder (simple)

- EGP 0–500/week: organic + community + seeding.
- EGP 500–3,000/week: add conversion retargeting + boost best Reel.
- EGP 3,000+/week: always-on ads + weekly creative testing.

6. Offers that work (without discount addiction)

Your offer is the bridge between attention and purchase. A weak offer forces you to discount. A strong offer increases conversion *without* destroying margin.

Offer type	How it works	Best for	Risk / when to avoid
Free shipping threshold	Free shipping above X EGP	Increase AOV	If shipping cost kills margin
Bundle	2–3 complementary items together	Increase AOV + move inventory	Bundling random leftovers
Limited drop	Clear end date + limited quantity	Urgency + brand heat	Fake scarcity (kills trust)
Gift with purchase	Low-cost, high-value add-on	Perceived value	Expensive freebies without margin
Loyalty credit	Points/credits for repeat	Increase repeat rate	Complex program too early

Rule

- Discounts should solve a specific problem (hesitation, AOV, stock). If you can't name the problem, don't discount.

7. Social media playbooks by platform

Pick 1 main platform + 1 secondary. Do not try to win everywhere. Consistency beats novelty.

Platform	What works best	Content formats	Common mistake
Instagram	Aesthetic + proof + community	Reels, carousels, stories, collabs	Posting only photos with no narrative
TikTok	Raw storytelling + trend agility	Short videos, stitches, lives	Too polished; no hook in first second
YouTube Shorts	Evergreen discovery	Shorts repurposed from TikTok	Inconsistent uploads
WhatsApp	High intent and conversion	Broadcasts, groups, drop announcements	Spamming offers without value

Story-to-sale structure (works on all platforms)

- Hook (0–2s): problem or curiosity
- Proof: show fabric/fit/result
- Context: why it matters
- Offer: price/value or drop details
- CTA: DM keyword / link / comment

8. Paid promotion (Meta/TikTok): a clean setup

Ads are a distribution amplifier. They do not create demand. Your job is to feed the system with strong creative and a clear offer.

Layer	What to run	Creative	Goal
Cold (new people)	Video views or traffic (testing) + conversion (winners)	Hook + proof + lifestyle	Find winning angles
Warm (engaged)	Retargeting (IG engagers, site visitors)	UGC, reviews, FAQs	Reduce doubt
Hot (cart/checkout)	Abandoned cart retargeting	Urgency + guarantee	Close the sale

Creative testing rule

- Test 5–10 creatives per week.
- Kill losers fast (no engagement, no clicks).
- Scale winners slowly (20–30% budget increase per day).

9. Influencers, seeding, and affiliates

Influencers are not a magic button. You are buying distribution and credibility. Micro-influencers often outperform macros for early brands because the audience trusts them.

Type	Typical deal	Best for	Risk
Seeding	Free product for content (no guarantee)	UGC library + social proof	No post; low quality content
Paid post	Fixed fee for deliverables	Predictable output	Weak conversion if audience mismatch
Affiliate	Commission per sale	Aligned incentives	Tracking issues; fraud risk
Whitelisting	Run ads through creator handle	Higher CTR and trust	Requires permission + process

Influencer selection checklist

- Audience location matches your buyers.
- They already sell (not just entertain).
- Their comments look real (not bots).
- They can show your product clearly (fit, detail).

10. Promotions that do not destroy your brand

Discounting is the fastest way to train customers to wait. Use it like a scalpel, not a lifestyle.

Tactic	Best use	Do this	Avoid this
First order incentive	Convert hesitant buyers	Small % or free shipping with threshold	Huge discounts that erase margin
Bundle pricing	Increase AOV	Bundle complementary items	Bundling random leftover stock
Limited-time drop	Drive urgency	Clear end date + limited qty	Fake scarcity
Gift with purchase	Add perceived value	Low-cost, high-value gift	Expensive freebies without margin
Loyalty reward	Increase repeat	Points or credits	Complex program early

Margin protection

- Never discount below your contribution margin.
- If you must discount deep, reduce SKUs and clear inventory fast.
- Use price anchoring: show original value + what stays premium.

11. Community promotion (WhatsApp) that converts

WhatsApp is not “spam”. It’s your highest-intent channel if you give value. Treat it like a mini-media company.

Message type	What to send	Best for	Common mistake
Value drop	Care tips, styling tips, size help	Trust + retention	No CTA ever (no sales)
Drop announcement	What’s new + why it matters + link	Launch conversion	No context; only link
Proof blast	UGC, reviews, screenshots, before/after	Reduce doubt	Fake proof (kills trust)
Scarcity reminder	Stock/ending soon + clear time	Urgency	Fake scarcity

WhatsApp rhythm

- 3 value messages for every 1 sales message.
- Use DM keywords (e.g., “SIZE” / “DROP”) to start conversations.
- Always include one next step: reply, link, or screenshot order proof.

12. Measurement and KPIs that matter

If you do not measure, you cannot improve. Track the minimum set that tells you if promotion is working.

Area	Metric	Why it matters	Healthy direction
Content	Saves/Share rate	Signal of value and distribution	Up
Traffic	Link CTR	Whether content drives action	Up
Store	Conversion rate (CVR)	Trust and offer clarity	Up
Ads	CPA	Cost to acquire customer	Down
Ads	ROAS and MER	Efficiency (channel vs total)	Up
Retention	Repeat purchase rate	Brand strength	Up

Interpretation (fast)

- High saves, low clicks: your CTA is weak.
- High clicks, low CVR: product page / price / sizing issue.
- Good ROAS, bad MER: you rely too much on paid; build organic/community.